



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Buffalo
School Website: <https://buffalochestertonacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School presents strong, explicit alignment with the classical, Christian tradition across mission, curriculum, and pedagogy. Its public materials repeatedly emphasize cultivating wisdom and virtue, the transcendentals (Truth, Goodness, Beauty), the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin, formal logic, rhetoric, recitation, debate, and a capstone senior thesis. The mission explicitly centers on glorifying Jesus Christ and partnering with families through a collaborative model that includes at-home "co-teachers." While we did not find explicit references to school-wide liturgy/chapel on the pages crawled, theological integration is clear (Christian Studies, Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics) and biblical texts are front-and-center. Faculty language tilts positive but is less detailed than other categories.

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Method note: Keyword findings were matched against the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators in the "Six Essential Elements" framework and supporting lexicon to estimate positive vs. negative indicators in each category (Religious & Metaphysical; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - "glorify Jesus Christ," "classical, Christian education," "wise, virtuous, and humble students" (mission)
 - "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "contemplation," "education is the cultivation of wisdom and virtue" (Classical Education Basics)
 - Bible citation (Philippians 1:9–11); overt biblical framing in "Message from Head of School"
 - Christian Studies sequence including Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics (Upper School plan)
- Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Positive indicators hit: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, theological integration (Christian worldview; sacred scripture; doctrine) align directly with Element 1 positives (e.g., "truth, goodness, beauty," "theology," "sacred scripture").
 - Liturgical/communal worship signals (chapel, liturgy, Eucharist) not explicitly found in the crawl; choir present but not identified as liturgical worship.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~15 (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom; Christ-centered mission; scripture; Christian Studies course names)
 - Negative hits: 0 (no values-neutral/relativism language)
 - Estimated percent positive: 100%

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- Estimated percent coverage of sub-dimensions: ~85% (strong on transcendentals and theology integration; weaker on explicit liturgical practice language)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (mission and Classical Education Basics)
 - “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (method)
 - “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
 - Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Direct match to “cultivation of wisdom and virtue,” “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty,” and formation over information .
 - No workforce/college-and-career-only marketing language detected (a negative signal) .
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~10
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated percent positive: 100%
 - Estimated percent coverage: 100% (all sub□aims clearly articulated)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) explicitly described, with stage□appropriate descriptions (memorization, recitation/songs; debate/discussion; rhetoric/senior thesis)
 - Great Books/Great Conversation named in overview
 - Latin (5th–8th grades), formal logic (8th), rhetoric instruction (10th)
 - History is taught as “History” (Ancient, Medieval/Renaissance, U.S.), not “Social Studies” (upper school sequence)
 - Christian Studies thread (Exegesis & Hermeneutics; Apologetics & Ethics)
 - Fine Arts including Choir and Shakespearean Theater (Logic School) and Rhetoric Choir (Upper School)
 - Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Positive: Trivium, Latin, Great Books/Conversation, integrated humanities, rhetoric/senior thesis—direct matches to the curriculum positives (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; integrated approach; wonder) .
 - Negative: no “Social Studies” replacement; no STEM□first marketing; one “project” (National History Day) appears but not “project□based learning” emphasis (a listed negative) .
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~18
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated percent positive: 100%
 - Estimated percent coverage: ~95% (Quadrivium terms not emphasized on crawled pages; otherwise comprehensive)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - Grammar stage methods: “memorization, recitation, and songs”
 - Logic stage: “debate and discussion” (argumentative/dialectical phase)
 - Rhetoric stage: “begins producing and defending his/her own ideas,” “thesis defense,” eloquent oral/written communication
 - Restful/Scholé cues: “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (method)
 - Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Positive: recitation/chanting/singing; debate/discussion (Socratic□adjacent), rhetoric/oratory/thesis—all listed pedagogy positives .
 - Negative: no “project-based learning” or “experiential learning” emphasis; “hands□on activities” appears once for early grades but is not a listed negative keyword (vs. “experiential learning focus”) in the pedagogy negatives .
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~9
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated percent positive: ~95%
 - Estimated percent coverage: ~90% (clear on memory work, dialectic, rhetoric; “scholé” specifically not named, though “contemplation” is present)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - “Head of School who loves Jesus and loves people,” “teachers who enjoy serving God by teaching students ... using the classical approach”
 - Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Positive ideals (teachers as models/mentors, living curriculum) are implied but not elaborated (no explicit “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or detailed teacher formation) .
 - No negative signals.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~3
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated percent positive: ~85%
 - Estimated percent coverage: ~55% (virtue modeling language present; limited evidence of faculty collegiality/formation profile)
 - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- Found keywords/phrases (site):
 - “co□laboring with families” (mission)
 - Collaborative schedule; parents as “co□teacher” for at□home days (Grammar and Logic/Rhetoric patterns)
 - Parent info meetings and campus tours; direct admissions contact invitation
 - Upper School Student Life mentions a “house system” (community culture)
 - Classical Education reading list offered to deepen understanding
 - Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
 - Positive: partnership with parents, parent formation (reading/resources), intentional community; all align with Element 6 positives .
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- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: ~7
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Estimated percent positive: 100%
 - Estimated percent coverage: ~95% (clear partnership/formation/community; open□campus hospitality implied via tours)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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Overall Assessment

- Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL
 - Rationale: Across five categories the site exhibits robust positive classical indicators with negligible negatives; Faculty language is positive but less fully developed publicly. The school's mission, theological grounding, Trivium□centered curriculum with Latin/logic/rhetoric, memory work and discussion□based pedagogy, and explicit parent partnership strongly match the Six Elements framework and lexicon .
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.